the team, in what was fast becoming the pattern of my Twenty20 career, in international cricket as well as in the IPL, I was more often than not held back in the middle order.

Our results improved in 2015, when eight teams participated in a double round-robin format, and we won seven of our 14 group matches, including four notable victories on the road.

We defeated Kolkata Knight Riders at the vast and noisy Eden Gardens, an impressive stadium where the playing experience can be spoiled by a dead wicket and a rock-hard outfield.

Virat's classy, unbeaten 62 guided us to a comfortable win over the Rajasthan Royals at the Sardar Patel Stadium in Ahmedabad, one of my favourite stadiums in the world ... the place where I scored an important double century in a Test, the place where I struck a quick century in an ODI (including probably the biggest six of my entire career, struck off the bowling of Harbhajan Singh and landing on the roof of the stands) and the place where lunch typically includes an exceptional pasta station, where you can choose your own ingredients.

RCB's successful travels continued with a win over the Delhi Daredevils at the storied Feroz Shah Kotla cricket ground, where we bowled out DD for 95 and Chris thumped an unbeaten 62 in a comfortable chase.

Our fourth away win was secured against Mumbai Indians (MI) at the Wankhede Stadium in the great city of Mumbai; it was a venue that had been transformed a few years earlier to the extent that, when we returned, it felt like a totally different place. The improvement in facilities was obvious and welcome, but the famous old stadium had character and quite a few fond memories were, quite literally, buried by the progress.

It was a memorable match against MI. I was given a chance to bat at number three, and Virat and I combined to add 215 runs for the second wicket, the highest partnership ever for any wicket in Twenty20 cricket. We ran efficiently between the wickets, turning ones into twos, and twos into threes, launching ourselves at anything slightly short or wide.